its requirements regarding the need to live by an Islamic code of life and the emphasis it placed on religious indoctrination. For example, would-be trainees needed to be prepared for Lashkar officials to conduct investigations into the state of the candidate's beard, his observance of prayers, and relevant family matters before issuing a recommendation.[44] Of course, personal relationships helped some recruits to access Lashkar's military training regimen more quickly than others.

The Daura-e-Khasa lasted three months and included physical training, small unit tactics, survival techniques, firing different types of light weapons and instruction on the use of hand grenades, rocket launchers and mortars. Lashkar disseminated a detailed primer outlining various aspects of guerrilla warfare and the specific requirements for conducting sustained attacks. It delineated the assets and capabilities an insurgent force needed as well as making recommendations in the areas of communications, medical aid, logistics and propaganda.[45] As already discussed, the army and ISI helped to design this training program, provided or oversaw military training and also trained Lashkar trainers. After completing this training the recruit adopted a kunya [nom de guerre] and was ready for battle. However, many were required to undertake additional proselytizing first. It has been suggested that recruits were also required to obtain their parents' consent to join the Kashmir jihad.[46] Anecdotal evidence based on interviews with current and former militants suggests this was not a hard and fast rule. Some obtained parental approval, while others did not and nor were they asked to get it. More important, according to several interlocutors, was that the recruit draft a letter or last will and testament, which stated he was not being coerced to wage jihad.[47] These letters were relatively uniform and, as detailed later in this chapter, often used for recruitment and fundraising purposes.[48]

Even after a recruit completed all of these requirements, some of those who were 'launched' [the term used for sending a militant across the LoC] received additional training before heading off to battle. This could include further training in guerrilla warfare, instruction in the use of heavy arms, or explosive training with a focus on making improvised explosive devices using locally available items or RDX [an explosive commonly used by jihadi groups in South Asia]. Some members, particularly those who might operate inside of India as recruiters or covert operatives, also went through